

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — Tasmania

Protect your money — Tasmania's bond system works a little differently.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works (A Distinctive System)

- ☐ [] **Know your bond is paid directly into the Rental Deposit Authority (RDA) via the MyBond system** — and critically, **tenants pay the bond directly**, rather than the landlord receiving and then lodging it. A landlord cannot receive or hold your bond themselves.
- ☐ [] **Know the maximum bond is 4 weeks' rent**, and it **cannot be increased** during your tenancy even if the rent goes up.
- ☐ [] **Know agents must process bond payments within 3 working days**.
- ☐ [] **Understand bond is not a general maintenance fund** — it can only be claimed against for legitimate reasons like unpaid rent or damage beyond fair wear and tear.

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ [] **Locate your original entry condition report** — your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ [] **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ [] **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ [] **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ [] **Complete the bond claim process together with your landlord where possible** — typically via a joint bond claim form submitted through MyBond.
- ☐ [] **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the landlord attends.
- ☐ [] **Keep every receipt** — cleaning, repairs, pest control — as evidence.
- ☐ [] **If the landlord proposes deductions, ask for reasons and evidence** — and request a copy of any invoice or receipt for repairs or cleaning being claimed against your bond.

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ [] **If the landlord agrees to return your full bond**, the RDA releases the funds per your joint instruction.
- ☐ [] **If there's a dispute**, this generally goes to the **Residential Tenancy Commissioner** in the first instance.
- ☐ [] **Know the appeal pathway**. Where the Commissioner can't resolve a dispute informally, the matter proceeds to the **Magistrates Court**.
- ☐ [] **Know disputes are usually resolved within 6-8 weeks**, and matters above roughly \$5,000 or of genuine complexity generally go to the Magistrates Court (Civil Division) rather than being resolved administratively.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ [] **Gather your evidence before lodging a dispute**: entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, receipts, and correspondence.
- ☐ [] **Remember Tasmania doesn't use a general tenancy tribunal** like most other states — your dispute goes to the Residential Tenancy Commissioner first, not TASCAT (which handles pet-consent disputes only).
- ☐ [] **Take time-stamped photos at move-out specifically to support a claim for a full refund** — this is standard, recommended practice given how document-dependent the Commissioner's process is.

Quick Reference — TAS Bond Process

ITEM	DETAIL
Bond payment	Tenant pays directly into the Rental Deposit Authority via MyBond
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent, cannot increase during tenancy
Agent processing deadline	3 working days
Dispute resolution	Residential Tenancy Commissioner, then Magistrates Court
Typical dispute timeframe	6-8 weeks

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown — not legal advice. For a specific dispute, contact Consumer, Building and Occupational Services (CBOS) Tasmania.